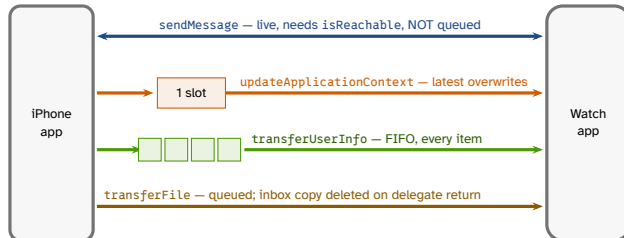
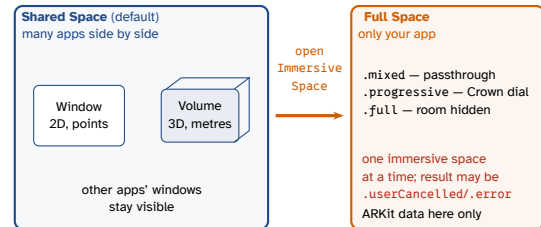


In one line: watchOS: a separate bundle on a separate device — glance-first, mostly suspended, talks to the phone through **WatchConnectivity** (four channels with different delivery guarantees) or the network itself. **visionOS: SwiftUI scenes placed in space** — **windows, volumes, immersive spaces** — driven by **gaze + pinch**, where the **system, never the app, knows where the user looks**.

WatchConnectivity — four channels, four guarantees



visionOS — where content lives



watchOS

- **Structure:** SwiftUI App (watchOS 7); one watch target since Xcode 14. Own bundle, version, install — no shared process or files with the iPhone app.
- **Independent** (WKRunsIndependentlyOfCompanionApp, or WKWatchOnly) vs companion: independent apps network themselves; WatchConnectivity is an optimisation. App Groups share only *on one device*.
- **Complications = WidgetKit** (watchOS 9; ClockKit deprecated): .accessoryCircular / Rectangular / Inline / Corner; timeline entries render without waking you. Widgets also fill the **Smart Stack** (watchOS 10), ranked by relevance.
- **Background:** mostly suspended. WKApplicationRefreshBackgroundTask; with a complication on the active face **≈4 refreshes/hour**. Complete every task or lose budget. WKExtendedRuntimeSession: fixed types (mindfulness, smart alarm...).
- **Workouts:** HKWorkoutSession + HKLiveWorkoutBuilder = the sanctioned long-running mode. HealthKit hides *read denial* — looks like no data. Always On: \.isLuminanceReduced.

WatchConnectivity table

API	Reachable?	Delivery · use
sendMessage	required	now or error; watch→phone wakes the iOS app in background, phone→watch does not · live request/reply
updateApplicationContext	no	background, latest only · current state, settings
transferUserInfo	no	background FIFO, survives relaunch · events that must all arrive
transferFile	no	background queue · images, audio
transferCurrentComplicationUserInfo	no	high priority, daily budget · complication data

```

let s = WCSSession.default // both sides: delegate + activate()
if s.isReachable {
    s.sendMessage(msg, replyHandler: nil, errorHandler: nil)
} else { try? s.updateApplicationContext(state) } // latest wins
// delegate runs on a BACKGROUND queue: hop to @MainActor

```

visionOS

- **Scenes:** WindowGroup (window) · .windowStyle(.volumetric) + .defaultSize(..., in:

.meters) (volume) · ImmersiveSpace(id:) + .immersionStyle. await openImmersiveSpace(id:) and check the result.

- **RealityView { content in }:** RealityKit entities in metres; update: syncs state; attachments: pin SwiftUI views to entities. TapGesture().targetedToAnyEntity() fires only on entities with InputTargetComponent + CollisionComponent.
- **Input:** *indirect* = look + pinch; *direct* = touch content in reach. The **hover highlight is drawn by the system out of process** — the app gets only the pinch-as-tap, never gaze. .hoverEffect(); targets ≥ 60 pt.
- **ARKit** (ARKitSession + hand / scene-reconstruction / plane / world providers): needs authorisation (NSHandsTrackingUsageDescription, NSWorldSensingUsageDescription) and an open immersive space.
- **Ornaments:** .ornament(attachmentAnchor: .scene(.bottom)) — controls outside the window.
- **Porting iPad:** “Designed for iPad” runs unmodified in a window; the visionOS destination adds glass, ornaments, volumes, spaces — then fix touch/hover assumptions and tiny targets.

Traps

- ! **updateApplicationContext for events** — the 2nd call overwrites the 1st; use transferUserInfo.
- ! **sendMessage while not reachable** — nothing queued; no fallback = data lost.
- ! **isReachable ≠ paired:** check isPaired / isWatchAppInstalled (iOS); iOS side must also handle sessionDidBecomeInactive / sessionDidDeactivate (watch switching) and reactivate.
- ! **Received file used later** — the inbox file is deleted when session(_:didReceive:) returns; move it.
- ! **“Log what the user looked at”** on visionOS — impossible by design.

Remember

Watch: “message now, context latest, userInfo all, file big.”

Vision: “window, volume, space — the system sees the eyes, you see the pinch.”